Every chapter includes exercises for you to test what you've learned, and the sample code contains answers. For example, `code/ch04e_exercises` contains all the code from chapter 4, including the answers to the exercises.

As RiffMates gets built while you go along, each subsequent directory includes code for everything before it. The `ch05a_admin` directory includes all the code, including all the exercise answers from chapters 2 through 4. Spoiler alert, if you go digging around in the directories for later chapters, you may come across some exercise answers. Sample code was processed using the Black formatter (https://pypi.org/project/black/), and as such, you may find cosmetic differences between it and code generated by the Django framework itself.

Source code and commands you need to run are represented in the book using a `fixed width font`. Code listings may include line-continuation markers (➥) for code that is too long to fit on a single line. Code annotations accompany most of the listings, highlighting important concepts.

Writing about a framework is a moving target. The code in this book was written and tested against Django 5.0. Django's version numbering system uses what is referred to as "loose semantic versioning," offering a new release every 8 months. Each major version number (the *5* in *5.0*) corresponds to three releases. For the *5* family, that's 5.0, 5.1, and 5.2. The *.2* release is a long-term support version, meaning that's where the bug fixes will go for a 28-month support period. A full list of release timings and support windows is available on the downloads page: https://www.djangoproject.com/download/.

Don't let major release numbers scare you; they may or may not correspond to breaking changes. When I started writing the book, I was coding against 4.2, and upgrading to 5.0 required no changes in the project. Between versions, features may get deprecated—see the release documentation for specifics if you're upgrading a project.

Django releases are tied to Python versions. I tested using Python 3.12, but as long as you're using a version that matches the Django release, you'll be just fine. I intentionally avoided any Python syntax changes only available in more-recent releases. A table showing which Python versions are supported with which versions of Django is available on the FAQ page: https://docs.djangoproject.com/en/dev/faq/install/#what-python-version-can-i-use-with-django. You can get executable snippets of code from the liveBook (online) version of this book at https://livebook.manning.com/book/django-in-action. The complete code for the examples in the book is available for download from the Manning website at https://www.manning.com/books/django-in-action, and from GitHub at https://github.com/cltrudeau/django-in-action.

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